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"Culture becomes real when it is reflected in everyday decisions—how growth is pursued, how risk is managed, how capital is allocated, and how accountability is upheld"

sector was opening up and India's economy was growing rapidly. Therefore, I had the opportunity to work across every facet of financial services.

I was also fortunate to be involved in several important milestones, including the ICICI-ICICI Bank merger. We executed some of the largest equity and debt raises of that time, including a landmark $5 billion equity raise for ICICI Bank.

When I came to Aditya Birla Capital, it gave me an opportunity to leverage everything I had learned over 30 years. The last four years at Aditya Birla Capital were very exciting as we have built scale, added new businesses, built teams and implemented some important strategic decisions like the merger of ABFL with ABCL. We have also significantly strengthened our capital base, raising approximately ₹11,250 crore.

If I were to talk about the key learnings, there is no substitute for integrity and sound judgement, particularly when you are managing people's hard-earned money and trust. The second learning is the importance of investing in people and building strong teams. Markets are volatile, and what really helps you scale a business and take it to the next level is having the right people in the right roles.